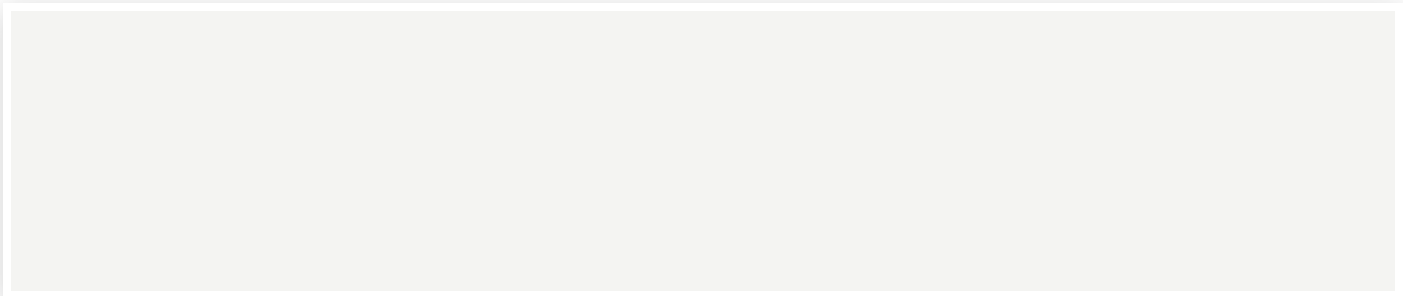


Built on bluffs above two rivers, at the place where American long-distance electricity began. West Linn is a city of separate old neighbourhoods — Willamette, Bolton, Robinwood, Cedaroak — stitched together by annexation and then by the freeway. **The geology and the river rules** shape what you can do with a lot here more than the zoning does.

1889 THE FIRST LONG-DISTANCE TRANSMISSION OF ELECTRICITY IN THE UNITED STATES	1913 WEST LINN INCORPORATED, CONSOLIDATING FOUR SEPARATE SETTLEMENTS	27,601 POPULATION, PORTLAND STATE ESTIMATE FOR 2025	\$842,442 MEDIAN SALE, THREE MONTHS TO AUGUST 2026, ON 124 SALES
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The price is Redfin's median closed sale across the three months to August 2026, on 124 sales — enough volume to be stable. Population is the Portland State Population Research Center estimate for 2025; the city's own tourism pages still cite a figure several thousand lower. Ask for an address-level analysis before pricing.



WEST LINN · THE BLUFFS ABOVE THE WILLAMETTE

HOW IT CAME TO BE HERE

Robert Moore settled the Willamette side in the 1840s, and the town on his claim was renamed Linn City in 1845 after Senator Lewis F. Linn. It did not last: Linn City and neighbouring Multnomah City were both destroyed by fire and flood in 1861.

What rebuilt the place was the falls. In 1889 the Willamette Falls Electric Company ran a fourteen-mile line to Portland — **the first long-distance transmission of electrical energy in the United States** — and a pulp and paper mill opened the same year. West Linn incorporated in 1913, consolidating West Oregon City, Bolton, Sunset and Willamette Heights; the town of Willamette merged in 1916 over water supply.

1845 Robert Moore's settlement is renamed Linn City; fire and flood destroy it in 1861.	1889 A fourteen-mile line to Portland carries the first long-distance transmission of electricity in the United States.	1913 West Linn incorporates, consolidating four separate settlements plus the mill lands.	1967 Cedaroak, Robinwood and Marylhurst are annexed, having been platted in the 1920s to 1940s.
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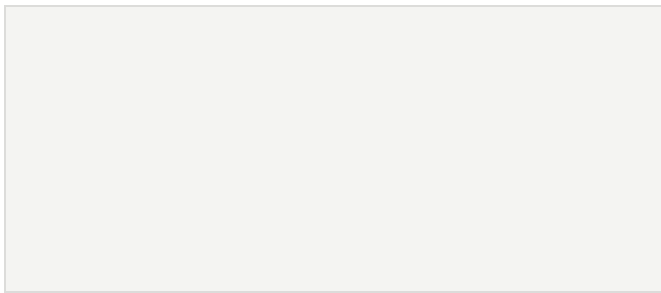
WHAT TO CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY HERE

- **Slope and landslide hazard.** The city sits on bluffs, and state landslide mapping covers it across three quadrangles. West Linn strengthened geotechnical and surface-water review by ordinance in 2017. Confirm the thresholds with planning before designing.
- **Three separate river overlays.** Flood management, river greenway and water resource area permits can all apply to one lot. The published water resource map is explicitly not suitable for site-specific decisions — boundaries need a staff visit.
- **Historic district review.** The Willamette Historic District was listed on the National Register in 2009. Inside it, any exterior alteration needs city approval, and demolition runs through its own chapter of the code.
- **Tree permits are species-dependent.** Six inches for Oregon white oak, Pacific madrone and Pacific dogwood; twelve for everything else. On a wooded bluff lot this collides directly with the erosion and river rules.

THE HOUSING

Older and more varied than the suburban label suggests. Willamette was platted in 1893 as a fully modern town — wired for electricity, with sewers and indoor plumbing from construction — and its Stick, Queen Anne and bungalow houses sit close together on a firm grid with detached garages. Bolton was platted in 1896.

Holly Grove and the Moody subdivisions followed in the 1920s and 1930s with bungalows, English cottages and early ranches; Cedaroak, Robinwood and Marylhurst brought attached garages and auto-oriented layouts. **Interstate 205 in the early 1970s drove the largest wave**, and pressure along Willamette Drive has converted and demolished older houses since.



PARKS AND DAILY LIFE

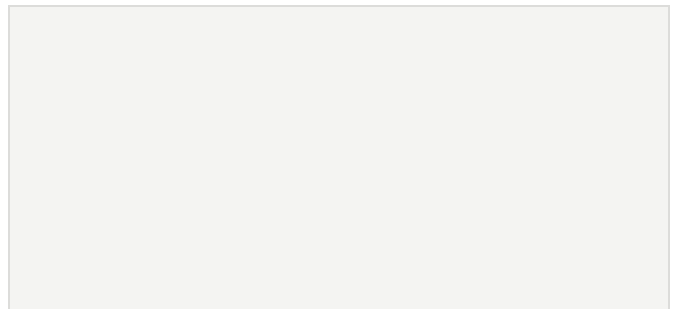
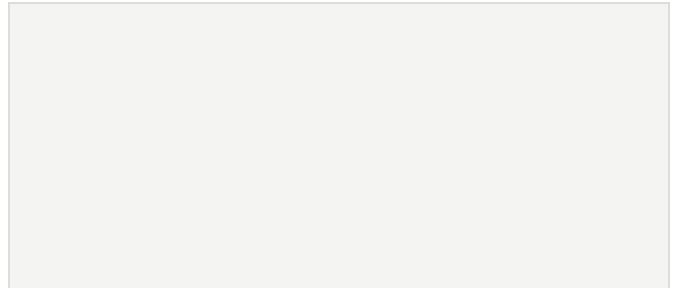
Thirty-one park sites. Mary S. Young State Recreation Area runs to about 128 acres on the Willamette, donated in 1973, with more than five miles of trail and an off-leash area. Camassia Nature Preserve is 22.5 acres owned by The Nature Conservancy on a rocky plateau scoured by the Missoula Floods, with rare plants.

Wilderness Park covers 51.4 acres and Willamette Park 22.5 at the river confluence. Historic Willamette Main Street on Willamette Falls Drive is the walkable commercial district, currently mid-streetscape project. The falls themselves — the largest in the northwest by volume — are best seen from the Oregon City side; the locks have been closed since 2011.

GETTING AROUND

Highway 43 runs the riverbank and is **two lanes through much of the city**, which is the single most important commute fact here. I-205 crosses the east side, and the 1922 Oregon City Bridge carries Highway 43 traffic across the river. There is no light rail.

Bus service thinned on 23 August 2026. Line 153 through Stafford and Salamo was eliminated for low ridership, which took the bus away from the hillside neighbourhoods off Salamo Road; line 35 still runs the Highway 43 corridor serving Bolton, Robinwood and Cedaroak. Any guide citing line 154 is out of date.



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